

Dong Jae Lee

Founder-Operator | Early-Stage Technology & Startup Ecosystems

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PROFILE

Founder-operator who has built, funded, and shut down an AI startup—and partnered with Apple, Meta, and Google on the other side. Technical foundation from KAIST; operational depth across AI, spatial computing, enterprise data systems, and early-stage ventures. Brings a problem-first lens to evaluating frontier technologies and the founders building them—where adoption is driven by behavioral necessity, not novelty.

EXPERIENCE

Changjo Architecture (Returned at CEO's request) Seoul, Korea

Architecture firm expanding frontier technology ventures

Strategy & Market Research, Contract

Feb. 2026 – Present

- Built a due diligence rubric and evaluation dashboard for structured company assessment across Space, GenAI, and Smart Agriculture.
- Research emerging AI agent ecosystems to evaluate venture opportunities; analyze macro technology shifts shaping the next platform cycle.

Devs United Games, Inc.

Seoul, Korea

XR game studio for spatial computing platforms

Director, Business & Publishing Division

Feb. 2024 – Aug. 2025

- Drove **55.47% YoY revenue growth** in H1 2025 by securing entry into Meta Quest+ after assessing cannibalization risk, then redesigning promotions and DLC strategy.
- Led Apple partnership from cold outreach to launch, delivering iterative demos and launching Fishing Haven on Vision Pro—an **Apple App Store Awards finalist**—within 9 months.
- Initiated Google Android XR partnership by leveraging prior Meta and Apple track record. Secured dev kit access, negotiated upfront funding terms, and managed cross-functional porting.
- Renegotiated a previously dropped Meta funding deal; after analyzing revenue-share vs. capital, walked away—preserving equity and positioning the company for a stronger raise.

Changjo Architecture

Seoul, Korea

Business Development, Contract

Sept. 2023 – Feb. 2024

- Launched an indoor farming initiative; built domain knowledge in controlled environment agriculture, market sizing, and technology benchmarking, leading to a dedicated Smart Farm division.
- Built and operated farming setups from scratch; devised a novel water-injection method to minimize water usage.

Flint Technologies Inc.

Seoul, Korea

Early-stage startup developing an AI knowledge management platform using Graph Neural Networks

Co-Founder & COO

May. 2021 – Feb. 2024

- Defined the MVP and built a data-driven decision culture across four co-founders by testing competing UIs and landing pages, using real user data to resolve strategic disagreements.
- Developed and executed the GTM strategy: identified early adopter segments, validated hypotheses through rapid A/B testing, and iterated based on user retention data.
- Raised seed from Strong Ventures and Fast Ventures at a **\$2.1M post-money valuation** and secured **KRW 450M** in government grants; managed investor relations at global startup events.
- Navigated two pivots before winding down after concluding the product lacked product-market fit, sharpening a problem-first lens carried into subsequent roles.

TmaxTibero *Enlistment as Technical Research Personnel (May 2018 – May 2021)*

Seongnam, Korea

Multinational corporation specializing in enterprise data management systems

Team Lead

Jul. 2019 – May. 2021

- Translated enterprise infrastructure needs into product roadmaps through technical discovery and strategic planning with stakeholders at Samsung and Hyundai. Received **Achievement Award** for exceeding client expectations.

Software Engineer

Feb. 2018 – Jul. 2019

- Benchmarked database platforms (Oracle, Microsoft) and researched global trends in cloud infrastructure and AI-driven data systems to inform competitive positioning.

EDUCATION

KAIST — M.S. Mechanical Engineering, National & BK21 Scholarship 2015 – 2018

KIT (Germany) — Dual Degree, 65 ECTS toward M.S. Mechanical Engineering 2016 – 2017

KAIST — B.S. Mechanical Engineering & Industrial Design, National Scholarship · Dean's List 2010 – 2015

OTHER QUALIFICATIONS

- Languages: Korean (native), English (native), German (advanced, TestDAF 5/5/4/5)
- International: US, Austria, Germany
- Technical Literacy: AI/ML (RAG, LLMs, GNNs), Spatial Computing (Unity, VisionOS), DBMS